



GENERAL RELIEF PROGRAM FACT SHEET

General Relief (GR) assists Los Angeles County residents who are not eligible for other State or federal cash assistance programs. GR includes a monthly cash grant of \$221 for a single person, or \$375 for a married couple, and access to supportive services. An average GR case consists of one person, living alone, with no income or resources.

ELIGIBILITY REQUIREMENTS

To be eligible for GR, an individual must be a resident of Los Angeles County and be a U.S. citizen or have a satisfactory immigration status. The GR eligibility requirements are:

- Monthly net income is lower than the maximum GR grant of \$221 for one person or \$375 for a married couple.
- Personal property has a combined value of \$2,000 or less.
- The property limit for an owned motor vehicle used as a residence is \$11,500. Motor vehicles not used as a residence must be valued at \$4,500 or less to be eligible for aid. The property limit for a mobile home used as a residence is \$15,000. Only one motor vehicle may be retained per household.
- Cash on hand or in a bank account is valued at \$100 or less for single applicants, \$200 or less for couple/family applicants, or \$1,500 or less after GR is approved.
- Real Property (residence) has an assessed value of \$34,000 or less and applicants agree to sign a lien, allowing the County to recover GR payments received under certain circumstances.

An individual is ineligible for GR if they are:

- In violation of probation or parole.
- Fleeing to avoid prosecution or custody/confinement after a felony conviction.

GR APPLICATION

Residents of Los Angeles County may apply for GR in person in a Department of Public Social Services GR district office, over the phone by calling the Customer Service Center at (866) 613-3777, by mail, fax, or online through [BenefitsCal](https://www.benefitscal.com).

SUBSTANCE USE DISORDER REQUIREMENT

GR applicants may be pre-screened for a Substance Use Disorder (SUD) if there is a reasonable suspicion of a disorder. If there is an indication of a disorder from the pre-screening, the GR applicant is referred to the Department of Public Health for a formal screening. If at the screening appointment, the applicant is determined to have a SUD, the applicant may still be approved for GR if all other eligibility criteria are met, and must participate in a treatment program as a condition for continued eligibility for GR.

SERVICES AVAILABLE:

Emergency Aid

If potentially eligible for GR, the following aid may be available while GR is pending:

- Aid to prevent eviction/foreclosure.
- Aid to prevent utility shut-off or to restore utilities.
- Aid until receipt of first paycheck.
- Transportation to seek employment/keep medical appointments, etc.
- Personal care items.

Special Needs

- A transportation allowance to seek employment.
- A special/therapeutic diet allowance as verified by a doctor.
- An allowance for uniforms and tools needed to begin a new employment.

Health Care

Most GR applicants/participants are eligible for Medi-Cal benefits.

Countywide Benefits Entitlement Service Team (CBEST)

Staff at Community Based Organizations contracted by the Department of Health Services (DHS) provide advocacy services telephonically to help physically/mentally disabled individuals apply for Supplemental Security Income (SSI)/State Supplemental Payment (SSP) and become self-sufficient. If approved for SSI/SSP, the maximum monthly grant is \$1,206.94 versus the monthly GR grant of \$221. SSI recipients also receive full-scope Medi-Cal.

GR Caseload Types

The employability status of GR applicants and participants is initially determined through self-declaration. If a GR applicant/participant declares that a physical or mental health condition prevents participation in employment-related activities, verification is requested from a primary care provider or treating professional. The GR caseload includes the following employability status classifications:

Employable

GR applicants/participants who can participate in employable-related activities are considered employable. Employable participants are required to participate 20 hours per week in the Skills & Training to Achieve Readiness for Tomorrow (START) program, formerly known as the GROW program, to help them find employment. An employable participant may receive GR benefits for a maximum of 277 days out of any 365-day period. GR participants who have some limitations/restrictions in the type of work they can perform are considered employable. GR participants determined to be employable with restrictions are required to participate in the START program. Participation in the START program is limited by the functional limitations/restrictions determined by the

primary care provider. For example, GR participants may be restricted to sedentary, light, or moderate work due to their physical health condition.

Medical Unemployable

A Medical Unemployable is a designation given to applicants/participants who have a physical health condition(s) that prevents individuals from working or participating in employment-related activities. GR eligibility for unemployable GR participants is not time limited nor are they required to participate in the START program. GR participants with Permanent Unemployable status must apply for SSI and be referred to a CBEST Advocate for assistance. CBEST staff offer benefits application assistance and evaluate the need for supportive services.

Administratively Unemployable (AU)

GR participants who are not able to work due to circumstances other than physical or mental health conditions may be designated AU. For example, an AU designation may be assigned because an adult individual provides full-time care to an incapacitated family member or is 60 years of age or older. GR eligibility is not time-limited for AUs, and they are not required to participate in the START program.

Needs Special Assistance (NSA)

GR applicants/participants with confirmed mental health condition(s) are designated as NSA. Individuals designated as NSA are given priority treatment in the district office. In the event an individual is unable to comply with or complete GR requirements due to a mental health condition, some eligibility requirements may be temporarily deferred. GR eligibility for NSA individuals is not time-limited and they are not required to participate in the START program. GR applicants/participants have the option to schedule a mental health evaluation with Department of Mental Health staff remotely or on site at the district office or with their treatment provider. Potentially SSI eligible NSA individuals are referred to a CBEST Advocate for assistance with an SSI application.

Unemployable Volunteer

GR participants designated unemployable may volunteer to participate in the START program. Participation in the START program is limited by the disabilities or restrictions determined by the primary care provider. GR eligibility for GR participants determined Unemployable Volunteer is not time-limited, and there are no penalties for those who discontinue START participation or do not comply with the START program requirements.

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